

**REPORT TO: WEST OF ENGLAND COMBINED AUTHORITY COMMITTEE**

**DATE: 5 JUNE 2026**

**REPORT TITLE: DELIVERY ASSURANCE**

**RESPONSIBLE OFFICER: DIRECTOR OF FINANCE, INVESTMENTS AND COMMERCIAL**

**Key Decision No**

**Purpose of Report**

To consider changes to schemes within the Investment Fund programme against the agreed delivery assurance principles.

**Recommendation**

The West of England Combined Authority Committee:

- 1) Approves the change requests for schemes within the current Investment Fund programme as set out in Appendix 1.
- 2) Agrees the flexibility to allow the West of England Combined Authority, Bath & North East Somerset Council, Bristol City Council and South Gloucestershire Council to move CRSTS risk budgets between CRSTS projects within their respective CRSTS programmes, subject to the criteria set out in paragraphs 5 and 6 in this report.

**Reasons for recommendation**

Change requests outside previously agreed tolerances for delegated decisions require Committee approval.

It is recommended that the Committee approve an amendment to the CRSTS programme's change control tolerances, reflecting the programme's transition into delivery and the continuing development of cost management maturity across the region.

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| <b><u>Voting arrangements</u></b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| In order to be carried, a decision on this matter requires a majority of the members present and voting. Such majority is to include the Mayor. Each member present may cast one vote. If a vote is tied the decision is not carried. There is no casting vote. Co-opted members are not entitled to vote. |
| <b><u>Publication Requirements</u></b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| For publication.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

## Background

1. At the West of England Mayoral Combined Authority (MCA) Committee meeting in July 2022, a set of delivery assurance and budgetary principles were agreed to drive the delivery of projects and good practice, one of which was the Portfolio Review Board (PRB) comprising the West of England MCA and Unitary Authority S73/S151 officers and Directors. An updated Terms of Reference of the PRB were agreed by the West of England MCA Committee in January 2024.
2. To support timely decision making, in September 2022 a set of Investment Fund delegations to manage change requests were granted to the MCA Director of Infrastructure in consultation with the Directors of Infrastructure of the Unitary Authorities for schemes within the infrastructure portfolio. In October 2023, the MCA granted equivalent delegations to the Director of Environment in consultation with the Directors of Environment of the relevant Unitary Authorities for change requests for schemes within the Green Recovery Fund programme.
3. At the MCA Committee in July 2025, the authority to approve change requests within approved budgets, for schemes in the transport portfolio within the Investment Fund and CRSTS programmes, was delegated to the Executive Director for Transport of the West of England Combined Authority in consultation with the West of England Combined Authority S73 Officer, Infrastructure Directors and S151 Officers from the Unitary Authorities.
4. At the MCA Committee in March 2026, the authority to approve all CRSTS change requests was delegated to the West of England Combined Authority's Executive Director for Transport in consultation with the West of England Combined Authority S73 Officer, equivalent Directors from the Unitary Authorities, and S151 Officers.

## **Key Considerations**

### **CRSTS Risk Budgets**

5. The CRSTS Programme is carrying out a lesson learned review. As part of this review the Programme held a discussion with the CRSTS Board where it was recommended that further flexibility be provided for schemes that are in delivery. The Board agreed to proceed with providing flexibility to move risk funding between CRSTS only projects that already have full business cases approved and delivery funding awarded. This flexibility would apply only to projects with an approved final business case and where there is no change to agreed scope or outcomes, no impact on local contribution commitments, and continued compliance with the agreed delivery milestones of contractual commitment by March 2027 and completion by March 2029.
6. Each organisation would be required to submit a change request to the CRSTS Board on a quarterly basis that provides a summary of any movements of risk and contingency budgets between projects. The change request would include details about any consequent impacts on drawdowns, their timing, and spend profiles, supported by the appropriate audit trail. The change requests will be for noting by the CRSTS Board and will then be published as an officer decision to support the grant funding mechanism.
7. The Programme is currently working alongside the colleagues from the PMO, Finance, Grant Assurance and Delivery Leads across the four organisations to ensure that the risk budgets for each project are clear, and to finalise the detailed guidance and conditions for this process. A detailed proposal will then be presented for approval at the CRSTS board to enable the process to be implemented.

### **Delivery Assurance**

8. In spring 2025, a CRSTS Programme Board was established to provide oversight and assurance of the totality of CRSTS programme investment, and collectively hold responsibility for monitoring portfolio progress and resolving issues that may compromise delivery and benefits realisation. This brings together the MCA and UA transport Directors and S151/S73 officers, and in respect of CRSTS scheme changes this effectively functions as the PRB. On this basis, a number of change requests have been recommended for approval through the CRSTS Programme Board and approved through previously agreed delegations.
9. In April 2026, a Joint Regional Directors Forum (JRDF) was established with the aim to provide a regular opportunity to support decision making, information sharing and development of proposals relevant to the West of England Combined Authority. The membership of this Forum includes the Combined Authority and UA Directors. The Terms of Reference of the JRDF include consideration of Change

Requests recommended for approval at the MCA or Joint Committee and as such the JRDF will act as the PRB going forward.

### *Change Request for Schemes in the Current Programme*

10. In line with the agreed process, the JRDF considered a number of change requests on 7 May 2026. A total of 32 projects have submitted change requests which fall outside of agreed thresholds for delegated decisions and are recommended by the JRDF for Committee approval. These are set out in Appendix 1. As requested at the Overview and Scrutiny Committee meeting in October 2025, a short description of each project is provided alongside the reporting of the change to provide context.
11. The following schemes seek changes to funding from the Investment Fund which would together increase the headroom by £753k:
  - **Green Growth Impact Fund** – £523k revenue to be returned.
  - **FWD (formerly ISTART) Phase 0** – delivered £230k under budget.
12. In addition, it is proposed that £817k underspend from the Mayoral Priority Skills Fund is to be returned to the Employment and Skills Fund allocation.
13. The following projects are seeking the approval of change requests, as set out in Appendix 1, to reflect significant rescheduling of key milestones or project extension (more than 6 months) or reprofiling funding forward between financial years (£500k plus):
  - **Bath River Line Phase 1**
  - **Hengrove Park Enabling Works**
  - **Yate Park & Ride**
  - **Kingswood Regeneration Project**
  - **Local Industrial Strategy Productivity Challenge Delivery**

### **Alternative Options Considered**

14. All change requests are required to set out in detail the full range of options considered and the reason the preferred option has been identified.

### **Consultation and Engagement**

15. Engagement has taken place with officers in the West of England MCA and Unitary Authorities including consideration by the Joint Regional Directors Forum. The Board supported the approval of the change requests set out in Appendix 1 of this report.

16. The flexibility to move risk funding between CRSTS projects has been discussed with the CRSTS Board who are supportive.

### **Key Risks**

17. Project business cases set out the way in which risk will be managed and include a risk register identifying key risks to project delivery. These business cases are published at the point of approval by the West of England MCA.
18. All projects underway maintain a specific risk register as part of the project management and monitoring arrangements. Key risks are included in regular Highlight Reports.

### **Diversity, Equity and Inclusion Implications**

19. In developing the proposals set out in this paper, consideration has been given to the Public Sector Equality Duty under the Equality Act 2010. This report primarily relates to delivery assurance, reprofiling and change requests for schemes within the current programme. The equality implications therefore sit mainly in how changes to scope, timing or delivery may affect when and how different groups experience the intended benefits of each scheme. Where projects support active travel, public realm, housing, regeneration, green space, climate resilience, skills, digital access or employment outcomes, teams should continue to consider accessibility, inclusive design, safety, community engagement and the potential for delayed benefits to affect some communities more than others. Where any change request materially alters scope, delivery approach or intended outcomes, the relevant equality analysis or EqlA should be reviewed and updated to ensure ongoing compliance with the Public Sector Equality Duty.

### **Health Improvement and Health Inequalities**

20. The promoting organisation will be responsible for ensuring that any health implications are considered through the relevant project governance and management processes in enacting the proposed project changes set out in Appendix 1 of this report.

### **Climate Change Implications**

21. The MCA has committed to addressing the climate and ecological emergencies and reiterated these commitments through proposals in the regional growth strategy.
22. The Green Growth West Fund (GGWF) was set up as an impact fund for the region, to support regional net zero infrastructure and SME growth. The closure of the fund and the return of the capital and revenue funding means that the

positive outcomes proposed for climate change will no longer be met through this route.

23. The other change requests relating to climate and nature projects are seeking changes to timelines – the impact will be a delay, but still delivering the same outcomes. The exception is Managing More Greenspace for Nature, which should achieve additional positive outcomes through utilising underspend from the project.

### **Financial Implications**

24. The change requests would increase Investment Fund headroom by £753k, reflecting £523k returned from the Green Growth West Fund and £230k from FWD Phase 0. A further £817k underspend from the Mayoral Priority Skills Fund would be returned to the Employment and Skills Fund allocation.
25. The remaining change requests do not increase approved funding but amend spend profiles, milestones, cost categories or scope within existing allocations. Reprofiled spend must continue to be managed within approved budgets, funding conditions and the overall Investment Fund programme.
26. The proposed CRSTS risk budget flexibility does not increase the overall CRSTS allocation. Any movements between approved CRSTS projects must remain within each organisation's programme envelope, maintain agreed scope and outcomes, and be supported by appropriate change control, audit trail and financial monitoring.

### **Legal Implications**

27. Each approved Change to a project will need to comply with any provisions for change contained within the relevant legal documentation. Legal Services will provide Project Teams with legal support in relation to each approved Change to ensure compliance with legal and governance requirements.

### **Human Resources Implications**

28. If the changes are approved and for situations that result in increased funding with the need for more staff resource than currently exists, HR will work with the relevant officer/lead to ensure the request to recruit approvals and CLT approvals are in place, followed by the Combined Authority's recruitment or agency process to appoint all posts – including fixed term, permanent, interim, agency or contractor.
29. In situations where funding is reduced, the Combined Authority's internal managing change and redeployment processes will be applied where applicable.

## **Commercial and Procurement**

30. If the changes outlined in the report result in amendments to any existing contracts, these will be subject to procurement regulations and will require the appropriate level of commercial governance, including approval from the Commercial Board. Further engagement with the Commercial team will be necessary to assess the implications in more detail.

## **Appendices**

Appendix 1 – Change Requests for Schemes within the Current Programme Recommended for Approval.

### **Background papers:**

None

### **West of England Mayoral Combined Authority Contact:**

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## Appendix 1

### Change Requests for Schemes within the Current Programme Recommended for Approval

#### Bath and North East Somerset Council

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Bath River Line (BRL) Phase 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Creating a central green spine to the Bath Enterprise Zone, the BRL will form a continuous 10km linear park through the heart of Bath, helping unlock the potential of the river Avon and transforming a neglected corridor into a model for sustainable development, community connectivity and active travel. |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                 | £1,765,000                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Investment Fund (IF)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                    | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £665,000 from 25/26 to 26/27<br>Revised profile £19k 22/23, £74k 23/24, £139k 24/25, £268k 25/26 and £1.265m 26/27                                                                                                                                                  |  |
| Stated reason for change: Completion of Phases 1A and 1B has resulted in delayed start on site due to contractor availability. However, all costs for project delivery are committed with contractors procured. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |

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| Project                                                                                     | FWD (formerly ISTART) Phase 0                                                                                                                     |            |  |
| Description                                                                                 | An integrated approach to skills and curriculum delivery, business incubation-based innovation and research based on a phased hub and spoke model |            |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                   | £1,360,544 |  |
| Source:                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                   | IF         |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                | Project completed £30,275 under budget with total award now £1,330,269.<br>Return of £200k IF allocation to the headroom.                         |            |  |
| Stated reason for change: Project completed under budget and allocation no longer required. |                                                                                                                                                   |            |  |

#### Bristol City Council

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| <b>Project</b>         | <b>Bristol Harbour Place Shaping Strategy</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |
| <b>Description</b>     | The strategy aligns with Bristol's Local Plan and key policies to guide area-specific planning and support the city's strategic masterplanning. It aims to accelerate development by clarifying infrastructure needs, incorporating, and building community support, and promoting sustainability. |  |
| <b>Funding awarded</b> | £283,000                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |



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| <b>Source:</b>                                                               | IF                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Cost/ Spend:</b>                                                          | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £2,006 from 25/26 to 26/27<br>Revised profile: £175,686 23/24, £72,560 24/25, £32,748 25/26 and £2,006 26/27. |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> Minor reprofiling to pay the final invoice. |                                                                                                                                                           |

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| <b>Project</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <b>Managing More Greenspace for Nature</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Description</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                    | This pilot introduces a scalable grassland management regime to enhance biodiversity and support nature-based targets across council land. Key outcomes include expanded nature-managed areas, improved river habitats, and community engagement, through outputs such as restored rivers, new ponds, habitat plans, and increased volunteer participation. |
| <b>Funding awarded</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                | £649,120                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Source:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                        | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Cost/Spend:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                    | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £26,527 from 25/26 to 26/27<br>Revised profile: £89,639 24/25, £318,496 25/26 and £240,985 26/27<br>Reprofiling across cost categories                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Scope:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Additional scope to commission woodland management plans for 7 highest-priority Sites of Nature Conservation Interest (SNCI) woodland sites at Ashton Court, Avon Gorge, Badocks Wood, Blaise Estate, East Dundry Slopes, Oldbury Court and Frome Valley, and Stockwood Open Space.                                                                         |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> Due to the project delivering as planned and budgeted, minimal contingency funding has been required to date. It is proposed to utilise some of the underspend for additional scope. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

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| <b>Project</b>         | <b>Hengrove Park Enabling Works</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Description</b>     | Early infrastructure investment unlocking and accelerating Hengrove Park, Bristol's largest regeneration site of 1,435 homes alongside a 22-hectare public park and mixed-use amenities. The funding supports strategic highways, early housing phases, and public spaces to create a new liveable centre in South Bristol               |
| <b>Funding awarded</b> | £19,830,987                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Source:</b>         | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Cost/Spend:</b>     | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £4,120,205 from 25/26 - 27/28 (£2,856,720 - 2025/26, £1,225,066 - 26/27, and £38,419 - 27/28) into 24/25 (£125,507) and 28/29 (£3,994,698)<br>Revised profile: £898,587 22/23, £2,735,650 23/24, £2,862,451 24/25, £4,403,145 25/26, £2,434,089 26/27, £2,500,000 27/28 and £3,997,064 28/29 |
| <b>Milestones:</b>     | Delays of up to 12 months across 6 milestones                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

**Stated reason for change:** Re-profiling and milestone delay owing to the need develop a revised MMC (Modern Methods of Construction) strategy due to national sector changes; delays securing planning consent; additional time for establishing the joint venture legal entity between Goram Homes and Vistry Partnerships; availability of resources/expertise; and land ownership transfer issues.

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Bristol City Centre & High Streets Recovery and Renewal Programme                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | The programme delivers support and investment across designated high streets in the city. It includes Business Support, Vacant Commercial Property Grants, and targeted interventions in the City Centre and across 12 high streets, focusing on events and street scene and greening enhancements.                        |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | £3,959,301 (£3,484,301 revenue, £475,000 capital)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |  |
| Cost/Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £97,168 (£2,332 revenue, £94,836 capital) from 25/26 to 26/27<br>Revised profile: £2,261,765 to 23/24 revenue, £767,621 24/25 (£752,621 revenue, £15,000 capital), £236,341 25/26 (£194,939 revenue, £41,402 capital) and £693,574 26/27 (£274,976 revenue, £418,598 capital). |  |
| Milestones:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Delays of up to 5 months across 3 milestones                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |  |
| Quality:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Addition of one new output:<br>'Improvements made to trading and visitor spaces at St Nicholas Market' with a target of 5 spaces.<br>Addition of one new outcome:<br>'Businesses supported and sustained / started at St Nicholas Market' with a target of 25 businesses.                                                  |  |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> Delays to securing contractor and completing related strategic transport works. A health and safety review of St Nicholas Market identified an opportunity to improve street lighting, resulting in additional surveys and site inspections.<br>Delays in spending funding for St Nicholas Market due to the council commissioning a new contract. During 25/26, the majority of Vacant Commercial Property Grants have been funded through the UK Shared Prosperity Fund, with four grants through the Investment Fund. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |

## South Gloucestershire Council

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| <b>Project</b>          | <b>Linking the Levels</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |  |
| <b>Description</b>      | Linking the Levels is landscape-scale partnership working to restore and connect nature across the Lower Severn Vale and South Gloucestershire, including the Severn Estuary. A two-year development programme is underway to prepare a full delivery plan and secure future funding. |  |
| <b>Funding awarded:</b> | £370k                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
| <b>Source:</b>          | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |  |
| <b>Cost/ Spend:</b>     | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £4,211 from 25/26 to 26/27<br>Revised profile £146,568 24/25, £178,221 25/26 and £45,211 26/27                                                                                                                                            |  |

**Stated reason for change:** Minor underspend in 25/26 and small change to cost headings.

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Yate Park & Ride                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | The scheme involves the creation of a new Park & Change facility on the A432 corridor in Yate. As an exemplary multi-modal interchange facility, which features best practice methods in sustainable design and construction, the Park & Change will offer residents the opportunity to interchange with a range of sustainable transport modes, enabling modal shift. |  |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | £4.651m                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £55k from 25/26 - 26/27 to 26/27 - 27/28<br>Revised profile £162k 19/20, £615k 20/21, £3.668m 21/22, £140k 22/23, £10k 23/24, £30k 26/27 and £25,684 27/28                                                                                                                                                                 |  |  |
| Milestones:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Delay of 24 months to Monitoring & Evaluation milestone (to Sep 26).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |  |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> The absence of a Project Manager meant the Council was unable to commission and manage the required post-completion Monitoring and Evaluation activities within the previously assumed financial years. Now that appropriate capacity is in place, reprofiling the remaining funding into 26/27 is necessary to enable delivery and to ensure compliance with funding requirements. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |  |  |

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Common Connections                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Common Connections is a 4 year grassland habitat improvement project increasing connectivity between 100 sites and enhancing access for people and wildlife. The project will take place across key sites in South Gloucestershire including Siston Common and Emersons Green.                                                                                                                                                       |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | £998,973                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £76,309 from 25/26 to 26/27<br>Reprofiling £50k from revenue to capital<br>Revised profile £111,406 22/23, £165,788 23/24, £180,009 24/25, £324,460 25/26 and £217,309 26/27<br>Revised revenue profile £90,713 22/23, £97,035 23/24, £89,921 24/25, £85,133 and £97,286 26/27<br>Revised capital profile £20,694 22/23, £68,753 23/24, £90,008 24/25, £239,328 25/26 and £120,023 26/27 |  |
| Stated reason for change: Delays in procurement and installation of cattle grids and associated infrastructure due to design compliance checks and supply chain lead times, in addition to the time taken awaiting Section 38 approval from the Secretary of State. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Kingswood Regeneration Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                     | The regeneration of Kingswood town centre through targeted investment in public realm improvements, including improvements to building facades and shop fronts and the restoration of the 'Whitfield Tabernacle', a grade 1 listed building as part of a wider regeneration programme for Kingswood. |  |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                 | £1.613m IF & £5.947m Economic Development Fund (EDF)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                         | IF and EDF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                    | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £1,606,000 EDF from 25/26 to 27/28<br>Revised EDF profile £32k 25/26, £4.309m 26/27 & £1.606m 27/28<br>IF profile £590k pre 23/24, £56k 23/24, £160k 24/25 & £807k 25/26                                                                                 |  |  |
| Milestones:                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Delay of up to 7 months across several milestones including project completion (to May 27).                                                                                                                                                                                                          |  |  |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> Delays to construction, additional time in receiving third party responses such as for survey work, and changes to key personnel all contributed to the reprofiled milestones. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |  |

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Frome Valley River Reserve                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | To acquire land to create a river reserve in Frampton Cotterell and agree heads of terms with a long-term management partner.                                                                                                                                                   |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | £1,106,377                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £42,903 from 25/26 to 26/27<br>Revised profile £8,031 23/24, £955,443 25/26 and £142,903 26/27<br>Revised capital profile £920,144 25/26 and £84,856 26/27<br>Revised revenue profile £8,031 23/24, £35,299 25/26 and £58,048 26/27 |  |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> Reprofiling of project underspend from 25/26 into 26/27 is required to finalise arrangements with a management partner, draw up plans for the reserve and submit applications for external funding for the next phase. This has been caused by a delay in getting a memorandum of understanding in place with an external management partner. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |

## West of England Mayoral Combined Authority

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| <b>Project</b>         | <b>Regional Evidence Portal Pilot</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |
| <b>Description</b>     | The pilot will develop a regional evidence portal as a shared service that provides data and evidence to regional partners including the Unitary Authorities, to support action on regional priorities with better, more consistent information. |  |
| <b>Funding awarded</b> | £50k revenue                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |
| <b>Source:</b>         | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |  |

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| <b>Cost/ Spend:</b>                                                                                                                          | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £42,921 from 25/26 into 26/27.<br>Revised profile £7,079 23/24 and £42,921 26/27. |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> Protracted contractual negotiations caused delays to contracts being signed with payment now due in May 26. |                                                                                                                               |

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Climate Resilience Work Programme                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | The Climate Resilience pillar of the Climate and Ecological Strategy and Action Plan creates a new programme of work for the region with the strategic aim of accelerating adaptation to climate change impacts and building a climate ready region. The funding will help build the region's capacity to understand climate risks, key vulnerabilities, and opportunities to build resilience to climate impacts.                                                |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | £300k revenue                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | No change to overall funding<br>Bringing forward £2,987 from 26/27 into 25/26<br>Revised profile £96,729 24/25, £86,258 25/26 and £117,013 26/27.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
| Milestones:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 6 months delay across 2 milestones including producing a portfolio of best practice from Jan 26 to Jul 26 and stakeholder engagement from Mar 26 to Sep 26.<br>Removal of the development of the West of England Climate Adaptation Strategy which is now out of scope for this funding with 3 additional milestones added for support for regional resilience planning, corporate adaptation planning and integrated water management, all scheduled for Mar 27. |  |
| Stated reason for change: The work programme has been reprioritised to ensure it aligns with the Growth Strategy and integrates effectively with the Spatial Development Strategy. Reallocation of time to support the work programme has necessitated the need for a budget reprofile. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |

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| <b>Project</b>         | <b>Digital Office Pilot</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |
| <b>Description</b>     | The Digital Office Pilot is a regional initiative to streamline engagement between councils and telecoms providers, remove deployment barriers, and create conditions for investment in digital connectivity. It delivers core services including data tools, standardised processes, and targeted interventions to accelerate rollout of digital infrastructure. |  |
| <b>Funding awarded</b> | £2,519,183 revenue                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |
| <b>Source:</b>         | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |
| <b>Cost/ Spend:</b>    | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £433,813 from 25/26 into 26/27<br>Revised profile £36,956 24/25, £519,223 25/26, £1,403,861 26/27 and £559,144 27/28.                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |

**Stated reason for change:** Delivery to date has followed a test and learn process, co-designing functions with councils including onboarding data sets. As a result, some planned spend dependent on council readiness and procurement timelines matured later than planned and procurements for specialist support followed longer-lead times than expected.

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Cultural Compact Start-Up Investment Phase 2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | The Cultural Compact Start-Up Investment Phase 2 primarily resources staffing and capacity within the Creative and Cultural service to deliver on the portfolio of programmes and projects including managing the Visit West relationship, delivering the flagship programme Culture West and supporting inward investment into the region's creative and cultural sector. |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | £748,327 revenue                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £240,279 from 25/26 and 26/27 into 27/28<br>Revised profile £45,760 24/25, £172,985 25/26, £264,791 26/27 and £264,791 27/28.                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  |
| Milestones:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 5 months delay to full business case development for future delivery pipeline (to Jun 26).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> Changes around the Target Operating Model (TOM) and current scoping and development of the Investment plans has delayed the submission of the Full Business Case. The reprofile better reflects spend on staffing, now the team are at full capacity. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |

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| <b>Project</b>         | <b>Climate Ready Region</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |
| <b>Description</b>     | The project is delivering across five workstreams as set out in the Climate Adaptation Report, published in early 2025. The funding provides staff capacity, as well as budget for consultants to help build the region's understanding of climate risks and key vulnerabilities, and support opportunities to build our resilience to current and future climate impacts. |  |
| <b>Funding awarded</b> | £300k revenue                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |
| <b>Source:</b>         | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |  |
| <b>Cost/ Spend:</b>    | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling spend between cost headings, moving funding from in-house staff costs to training providers/consultancy services.                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |
| <b>Milestones:</b>     | Deletion of 3 milestones relating to the corporate adaptation plan report and delivery of Tier 3 and 4 Priorities and replacing with 4 new milestones including building a regional evidence base involving commissioning spatial mapping toolkit and working with partners to improve resilience of communities and businesses, all scheduled for Mar 27.                 |  |

**Stated reason for change:** The work programme has been reprioritised to ensure it aligns with the Growth Strategy and can integrate effectively with work on the Spatial Development Strategy. The change to milestones better reflects the achievement of the work programme outcomes. Current staff are now funded through the existing climate resilience budget, enabling external support to be sourced to fill skills gaps where capacity is not available in-house.

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Local Industrial Strategy Productivity Challenge Delivery                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | The Productivity Challenge delivery programme commenced in 2020 to introduce and deliver a range of business support interventions and activities to create long term resilience and growth in productivity in the West of England economy. |  |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                              | £3.602m revenue                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |  |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |  |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | No change to overall funding<br>Bringing forward £8,998 from 26/27 into 25/26.<br>Revised profile £1,630,654 up to 23/24, £437,143 23/24, £437,839 24/25, £639,424 25/26 and £456,940 26/27.                                                |  |  |
| Milestones:                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Delays to the Good Employment Charter first phase closure milestone from Apr 26 to Mar 27.                                                                                                                                                  |  |  |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> The budget reprofile better reflects the current spend profile of the remaining Food and Drink sector support activity and the Good Employment Charter, now expected to complete by Mar 27. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |  |  |

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Innovation for Renewal and Opportunity                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                               | The Innovation for Renewal and Opportunity programme includes a series of projects that seek to catalyse growth in the West of England economy, such as via providing funding to SMEs to adopt advanced digital technologies, progress experimental development research and development (R&D) activity, identify and protect their intellectual property (IP), to increase digital inclusion and attract additional innovation funding into the region. |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                           | £6,316,715 revenue                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                              | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £403,532 from 25/26 into 26/27.<br>Revised profile £1,195,253 up to 22/23, £1,027,591 23/24, £1,653,512 24/25, £819,589 25/26 and £1,620,770 26/27.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |  |
| Stated reason for change: Payments to supported/commissioned organisations did not occur as previously forecast and staff recruitment was delayed whilst the Combined Authority strategic priorities were re-established. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |  |

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                   | West of England Regional Business Support Service (RBSS)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                               | The RBSS helps residents and businesses start-up, sustain, and grow by providing tailored information, advice, and guidance; targeted local enterprise support; and specialist programmes covering areas such as technology adoption, inclusive growth, sustainability, and sector development. Designed to boost productivity, strengthen economic resilience, support under-represented groups, and accelerate progress toward net zero, the service will reach more than 5,700 businesses and create jobs, new enterprises, and measurable productivity improvements across the region. |  |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                           | £4,909,480 revenue                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |  |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                   | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |  |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                              | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £97,050 from 25/26 into 26/27.<br>Revised profile £14,084 23/24, £1,092,756 24/25, £1,846,938 25/26 and £1,955,702 26/27.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |  |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> Forecast expenditure has been updated to better reflect the current spend profile for the remaining business support activities that are due for completion by March 27. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |  |

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Local Growth Plan – Capacity Raising for Large-Scale Regeneration                                                                                                                                                                          |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | The project provides funding to retain and build capacity in the Unitary Authorities to deliver against the Growth Strategy. The funding is focused on securing capability to develop and implement regeneration projects in Growth Zones. |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | £450k revenue                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £23,017 from 25/26 into 26/27.<br>Revised profile £426,983 25/26 and £23,017 26/27.                                                                                                            |  |
| Milestones:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 3 months delay to issue feasibility studies or business cases from Mar 26 to Jun 26.                                                                                                                                                       |  |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> The Bristol City Council programme took longer to deliver the Bristol Central Place Investment Plan and review of the Strategic Community Infrastructure Levy (CIL) than anticipated. It is also preferable that the work benefits from outputs of the Regional Housing Pipeline Review, commissioned by Homes England and the MCA, once received. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |



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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Employment and Skills Resource                                                                                                                                       |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Marketing support for the service area and funding for the Data Team Manager responsible for the development and ongoing support of the service area data Lakehouse. |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | £414,598 revenue                                                                                                                                                     |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | IF                                                                                                                                                                   |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | No change to overall funding<br>Repurposing the £45k allocated to Marketing to fund additional in-house staff costs.                                                 |  |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> Following the move to a centralised corporate marketing model where costs are funded directly by individual projects, the marketing budget has been repurposed to fund the Data Team Manager role for a further six months to better meet higher operational need. |                                                                                                                                                                      |  |

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Retrofit Accelerator – Supply Side Market and Capacity Building                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |  |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | The project supports decarbonisation of the region by increasing the supply side market and capacity of the domestic retrofit sector. Retrofit West CIC leads a consortium to deliver the project as the Retrofit West Business Support service which builds on regional strength in domestic retrofit to create new jobs and drive the green economy to meet the growing demand for retrofit services created by Retrofit West Advice |  |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | £2,382,407 (£2,292,407 revenue and £90k capital)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | No change to overall funding.<br>Bringing forward £148,251 overall from 26/27 into 25/26 (this total includes moving £30k capital from 25/26 into 26/27 in addition to £19,848 MCA cost allocation also moving from 25/26 into 26/27).<br>Revised profile £232,773 (revenue) 23/24, £822,340 (revenue) 24/25, £871,870 (£811,870 revenue, £60k capital) 25/26 and £455,424 (£425,424 revenue, £30k capital) 26/27.                     |  |  |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> Insufficient time was available for one college to utilise the £30k capital funding through their internal mechanisms, so this funding will be reallocated to the 2 remaining colleges to enhance provision. The budget reprofile will enable Retrofit West CIC to maintain a high level of project activity aligned with the release of the Government’s Warm Homes Plan whilst continuing to engage with relevant tradespeople, whose skills and knowledge in domestic retrofit will be invaluable to ramp up the rate of installations. The changes will help to ensure the MCA is ready to deliver ‘Warm Homes West’ aligned with the Governments ambition to scale up domestic retrofit from 2027 and colleges are prepared for the required training. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |  |  |

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Sustainable Innovative Finance Foundations for Wind Turbines (SIFFFT)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | The project is being delivered by Bristol Energy Network (BEN). It builds on the learning from the Ambition Community Energy wind turbine project in Lawrence Weston on Bristol City Council land. The project is a community energy project aiming to build a pipeline of sites suitable for wind generation and will carry out a range of environmental and technical assessments. |  |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | £1,551,400 revenue                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | No change to overall funding<br>Increased costs for community engagement, community power solution and technical services and Legal Services which have been offset through reductions in project management and reporting, environmental impact assessments and planning, professional and insurance fees.                                                                          |  |  |
| Stated reason for change: The programme has been updated to prioritise activity relating to preparing for a planning application, hence additional legal and procurement costs. Some of the activities have now been commissioned between the contracted specialist services necessitating the need to reprofile expenditure across more accurate cost headings. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |  |

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Culture West                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Culture West is a £3.1 million programme, designed to nurture the expansion of creativity and culture in the region, solidifying its position as a worldwide centre for creative and cultural innovation. This is an ambitious two-year programme that will open up the creative sector to more diverse talent, ensure more communities take part and create art experiences, and build a resilient sector that will drive economic growth in the area. |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | £1.5m revenue                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £46,071 from 25/26 into 24/25 and 26/27<br>Revised profile £25k 23/24, £705,999 24/25, £681,530 25/26 and £87,471 26/27.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |  |
| Milestones:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 3 months delay to the final report to Arts Council England (ACE) and draw down of the final payment from Mar 26 to Jul 26.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> There were minor delays receiving and paying final claims to all 17 delivery partners with the reprofiled budget now reflecting actual spend. The final evaluation report will be submitted to the Arts Council England alongside the final claim by Jul 26. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |  |

| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Nature and Health Strategy                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |  |
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| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | The project has been instrumental in formalising Nature and Health as a priority programme within the West of England Nature Partnership (WENP). Building on the foundations of the Green Social Prescribing Programme, this development ensures that nature and health will continue to have strategic visibility, a clear governance structure and the capacity to expand.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | £100k (£21.5k capital and £78.5k revenue)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | No change to overall funding<br>Increase in match funding of £4.5k taking the overall total match from £62k to £66.5k and overall project cost from £162k to £166.5k.<br>Reprofiling £8,457 from 24/25 and 26/27 into 25/26<br>Reprofiling £2,750 from capital to revenue reducing the overall capital from £21.5k to £18,750 and increasing overall revenue from £78.5k to £81,250.<br>Revised profile £27,414 (revenue) 24/25, £66,709 (£18,750 capital and £47,959 revenue) 25/26 and £5,877 (revenue) 26/27.<br>Small reprofile between budget headings reducing grants to increase the cost of the Nature and Health Coordinator. |  |
| Milestones:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 2 months delay to 2 milestones including completing surveys (to Apr 26) and the final outcomes report (to May 26).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |
| Stated reason for change: Allocating the remaining grant in this way ensures that the funds are used purposefully and supports the effective embedding of the Nature and Health Strategy across partner organisations. Without this change, there is a significant risk that the remaining grant would be underutilised, resulting in reduced regional benefits and missed opportunities to consolidate the progress made to date. The remaining capital costs could not be adequately spent within the nature health hubs workstream and are more effectively utilised on core coordination and delivery. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |  |

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| <b>Project</b>         | <b>Regional Employment Service (RES)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  |
| <b>Description</b>     | The Regional Employment Service (RES) oversees the management and delivery of Skills Connect and Future Bright support services (delivered through UA partners) and the <a href="http://www.skillsconnect.org.uk">www.skillsconnect.org.uk</a> website. The RES delivers regional employability and skills support which helps residents to either enter employment, upskill, reskill, progress within work, or re-enter the labour market. The Skills Connect website acts as an overarching single access point, providing a directory of all skills and employability services available to residents. |  |
| <b>Funding awarded</b> | £4,995,356 revenue                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |  |
| <b>Source:</b>         | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |  |
| <b>Cost/ Spend:</b>    | <p>No change to overall funding<br/> Reprofiling £97,021 from 25/26 into 26/27<br/> Revised profile £2,079,772 25/26 and £2,875,584 26/27.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |

**Stated reason for change:** Underspends predominately from staffing due to the need for recruitment at both the MCA and delivery Unitary Authorities and a proportion of web development costs now funded through Youth Guarantee helped free up funding for further development work in 26/27. The budget reprofile will continue to support programme delivery and ensure there is enough resource to deliver key milestones, outcomes and outputs throughout 26/27.

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | West of England Wildlife Index                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | A nationally innovative project establishing long term nature monitoring across the region to provide evidence base for change, baseline for the Local Nature Recovery Strategy and MCA nature targets and drive investment to most effective interventions at a landscape scale.                                                                                                                                                  |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | £306,800 (£7.5k capital and £299,300 revenue)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £10,811 from 25/26 into 26/27<br>Revised profile £4,383 (revenue) 24/25, £173,093 (£2,324 capital, £170,769 revenue) 25/26 and £129,324 (£5,176 capital, £124,148 revenue) 26/27.<br>Changes to cost category spend with increases to consultancy for specialist species costs offset by reductions in travel and subsistence, training and communications and engagement expenditure. |  |
| Milestones:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 4 months delay to the publication of the state of nature report (to Jun 26).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> The budget reprofiling will enable a full programme of activity to be delivered commencing in 2026. Specialist species consultancy has now been procured at an additional cost offset from savings in other areas such as training with most of the events provided by the Natural History Consortium as part of the Festival of Nature. The aim is to launch the publication of the state of nature report as part of the festival in June 2026. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |  |

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| <b>Project</b>         | <b>Local Wildlife Sites 30 by 30</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |  |
| <b>Description</b>     | Local Wildlife Sites are designated locally for their substantive nature conservation importance and form a critical part of the Local Nature Recovery Strategy and the region's ambitions of managing 30% of land for nature by 2030 (30 by 30). Many Local Wildlife Sites have not been surveyed in many years due to under investment in the governance and management systems leading to a risk of losing sites through development. This work aims to re-establish an effective Local Sites Partnership and roll out a programme of surveying, alongside setting out a road map and business case for the 30 by 30 programme. |  |
| <b>Funding awarded</b> | £95k revenue                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |
| <b>Source:</b>         | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
| <b>Cost/ Spend:</b>    | <p>No change to overall funding<br/> Reprofiling £80,867 from 25/26 into 26/27<br/> Revised profile £14,133 25/26 and £80,867 26/27.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |

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| <b>Milestones:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 2-6 months delay across 5 milestones including Biodiversity Net Gain (BNG) sites register from Dec 25 to Jun 26 and completion of the initial phase of work from Jul 26 to Sept 26.<br>Request to remove 3 milestones related to delivery. |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> Team resources have been diverted to time-critical higher priority work as the region's state of nature report increasingly gained momentum. This has led to reduced capacity to deliver the milestones for this programme with submission of the business case now expected by Sep 26. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Green Infrastructure (GI) Implementation                                                                                                                                                          |  |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | The funding and the Regional GI team it supports, aims to deliver the ambitions of the Joint Green Infrastructure Strategy, and to support and align GI delivery across the West of England area. |  |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | £423k revenue                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £12,626 from 25/26 into 26/27<br>Revised profile £97,041 24/25, £313,333 25/26 and £12,626 26/27.                                                     |  |  |
| Milestones:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 3 months delay to complete spend for third party support to finish the feasibility and development phase from Mar 26 to Jun 26.                                                                   |  |  |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> Bristol City Council were unable to claim their remaining portion of grant by the end of the 25/26 financial year due to delays procuring the feasibility survey work and competing priorities relating to the floating ecosystem project and progressing this work into the delivery phase. |                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |  |

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| <b>Project</b>         | <b>Green Growth West Fund (GGWF) and Investment Readiness Advisory Service (IRAS)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  |
| <b>Description</b>     | <p>The Green Growth West Fund (GGWF) is an impact fund for the region, which will support regional net zero infrastructure and SME growth. The fund leverages public investment to attract private capital, accelerating decarbonisation. It targets investment in renewable energy, low-carbon heat, building retrofits, and nature-based solutions.</p> <p>The Investment Readiness Advisory Service (IRAS) is a free, grant-funded consultancy commissioned by the Combined Authority and delivered by Bristol and Bath Regional Capital. It provides expert guidance to support businesses in preparing for investment, helping them navigate the journey to connect with the right investors.</p> |  |
| <b>Funding awarded</b> | £1m revenue                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |
| <b>Source:</b>         | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |
| <b>Cost/ Spend:</b>    | Reduction in revenue funding taking the overall project cost from £1m to £476,958 with £523,042 to be returned to the Investment Fund headroom.<br>Revised profile £85,714 24/25 and £391,244 25/26.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |

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| <b>Milestones:</b>                                                                                                                                                                       | Removal of the final 3 Green Growth West Fund milestones due to early termination of the project. |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> The £10m capital for the Green Growth West Fund was returned to the IF Headroom in March. The balance of revenue underspend is now also to be returned. |                                                                                                   |

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| Project                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Mayoral Priority Skills Fund                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |  |
| Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Phase one of Mayoral Priority Skills funding supports reducing gaps within skills for residents of the CA region by prioritising funding to those that can work with residents who most need the support. The funding is split into themes to support community learning, apprenticeships, Not in Education, Employment or Training (NEET), modular vocational training and Bus Driver bootcamps                    |  |
| Funding awarded                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | £2,580,664 revenue                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  |
| Source:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  |
| Cost/ Spend:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Reduction in revenue funding taking the overall project cost from £2,580,664 to £1,764,101 with £816,563 to be returned to the Employment and Skills Fund allocation.<br>Increase in match funding of £15,400 taking the overall match funding total from £3,199,315 to £3,214,715 and overall project total from £5,779,979 to £4,978,816.<br>Revised profile £206,302 23/24, £1,095,291 24/25 and £462,508 25/26. |  |
| <b>Stated reason for change:</b> The underspend was due to the second call for Union Learn West funding not taking place along with some providers not spending their full grant awards. Match Funding was prioritised over the Investment Fund to prevent external funds being returned to Central Government. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |

## Bath Avon Rivers Trust

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| <b>Project</b>         | <b>Farmer-led Nature Recovery Initiative</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |
| <b>Description</b>     | The Farmer-led Nature Recovery Initiative brings groups of farmers together in the Chew, Cam and Wellow catchments. These farmer clusters form a thriving network of farms practicing sustainable and regenerative agriculture, leading to a wide range of benefits for farmers, for nature, and for the wider community including improved soil fertility, cleaner waterways, reduction in downstream flooding and better-connected spaces for nature. Bristol Avon Rivers Trust (BART) facilitate the cluster, offering training and guidance to farmers on sustainable practices, and provide grants for 'quick win' interventions. |  |
| <b>Funding awarded</b> | £259,815                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |  |
| <b>Source:</b>         | IF                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |
| <b>Cost/ Spend:</b>    | No change to overall funding<br>Reprofiling £24,069 from 25/26 to 26/27<br>Revised profile £80,153 24/25, £121,769 25/26 and £57,893 26/27                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |  |
| <b>Milestones:</b>     | Delays of up to 12 months across several milestones including 100% of whole farm plans with targeted opportunities completed (to Dec 26).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |

**Stated reason for change:** The completion dates for these milestones have shifted back aligned to the previous approval for the extension of the project. After this approval, the project's remaining delivery was evaluated, and certain milestones were suitably adjusted to enable delivery of the remaining objectives by Dec 2026.

Underspend in revenue, with scheduled work to now take place from Apr 26 onwards now that grants are starting to be signed off and funding agreements issued to successful farmers. In addition, scheduled baseline monitoring in Feb has now shifted to a more optimal time in May/Jun 26.